

UNIT III

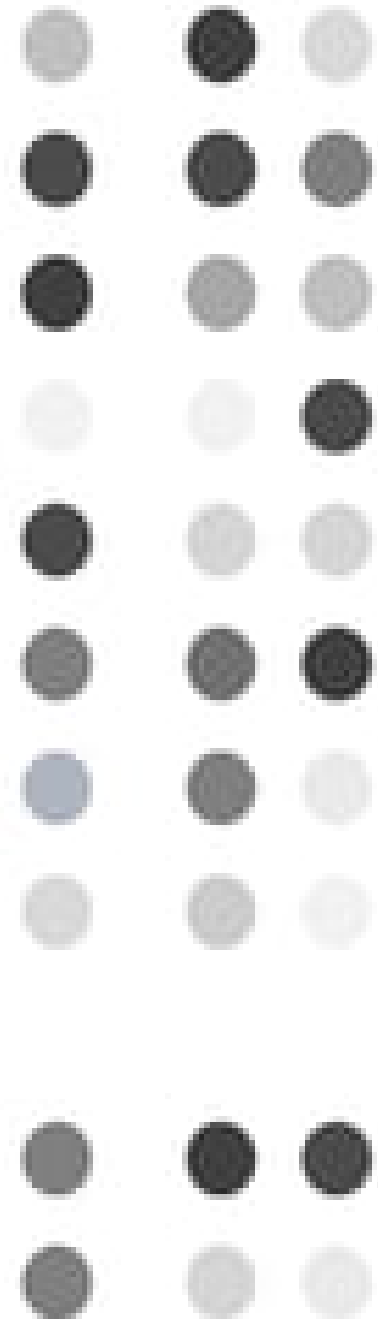
Technical Reading & Writing Practices

- Introduction to Technical writing
- Report writing
- Significance of Reports
- Types of Reports
- Introduction to Technical Proposal writing
- Types of Technical Proposals
- Characteristics of Technical Proposals
- Grammar-Voices & Reported Speech

INTRODUCTION TO TECHNICAL WRITING

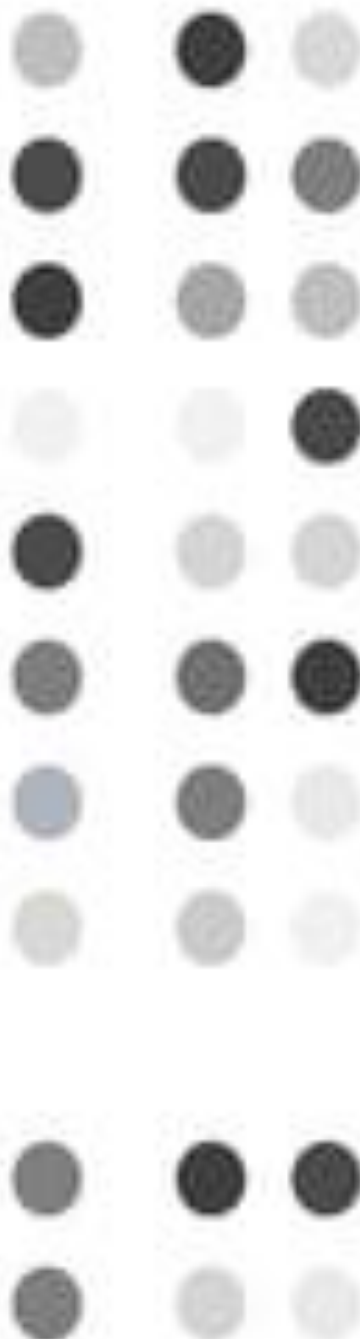
Definition

Technical writing is a type of writing where the author is writing about a particular subject that requires direction, instruction, or explanation.



Goals

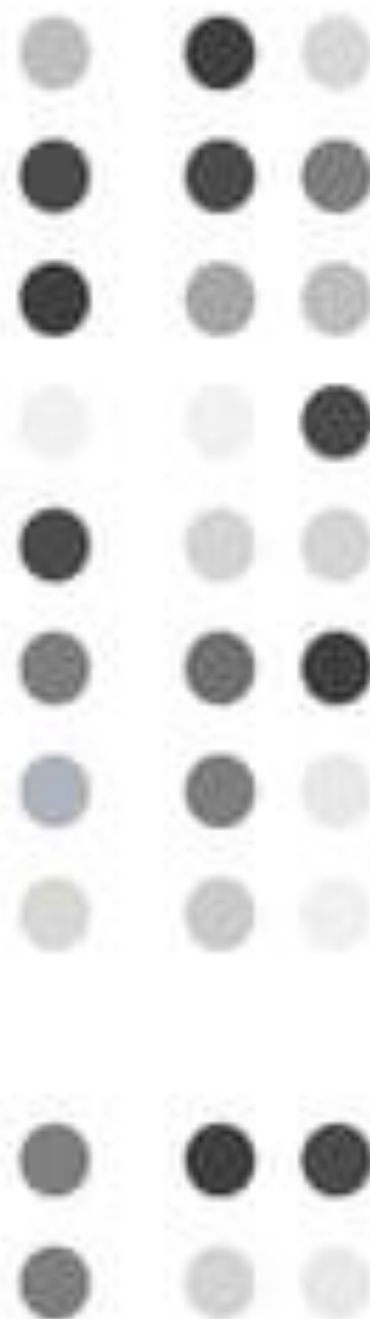
- To deliver technical information for readers in a manner that is adapted to their needs, level of understanding, and background.
- To communicate with specific audience, for a specific purpose.



Characteristics

- Understanding what is the purpose and why you are writing.

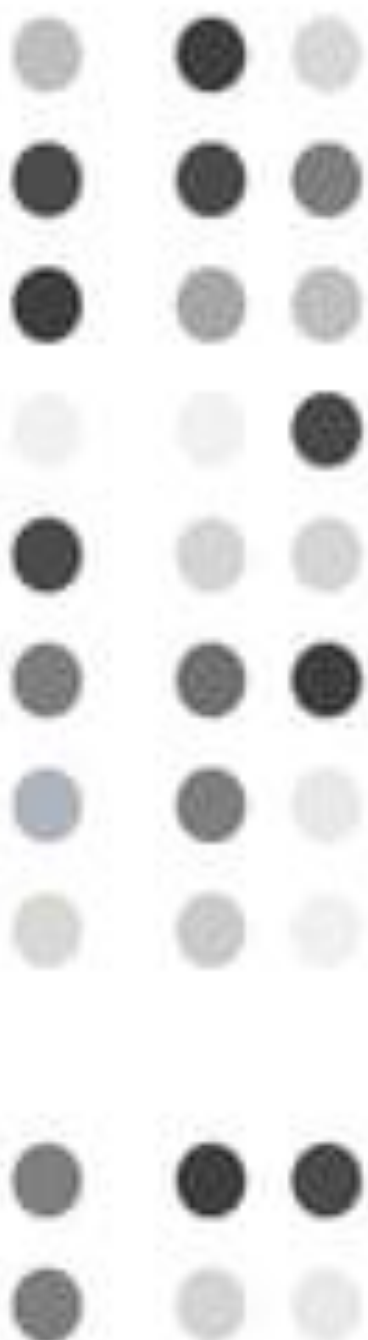
*To inform? To instruct? To propose?
To recommend? Or to persuade?*



Characteristics

- Writing for audience.

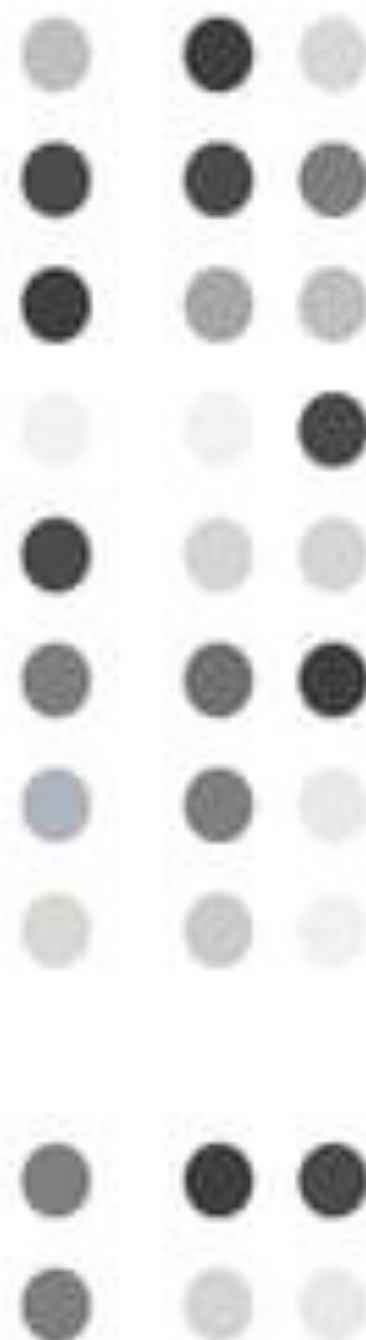
*Who is the audience? What is their background?
What do they need?*



Characteristics

- Satisfying document specifications
(Appropriate genre/type of document)

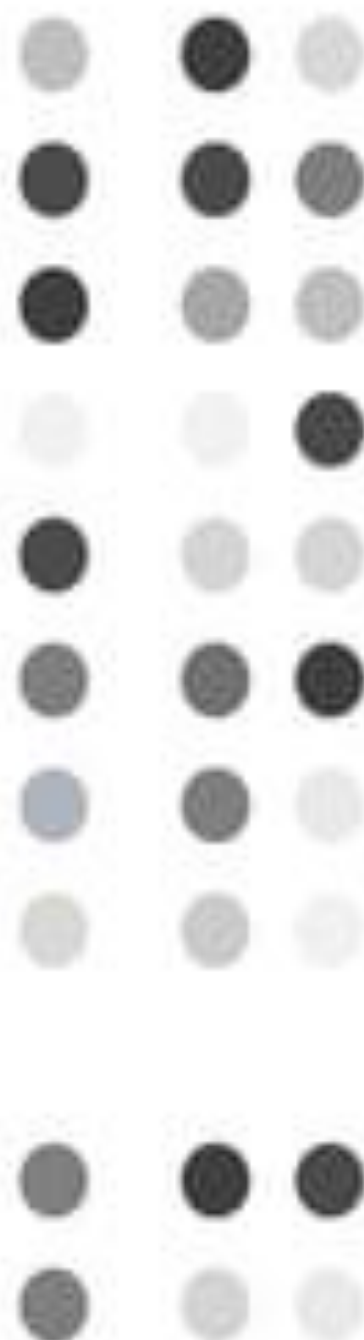
What is the document type?
How about the required format?



Characteristics

- Providing accurate information.

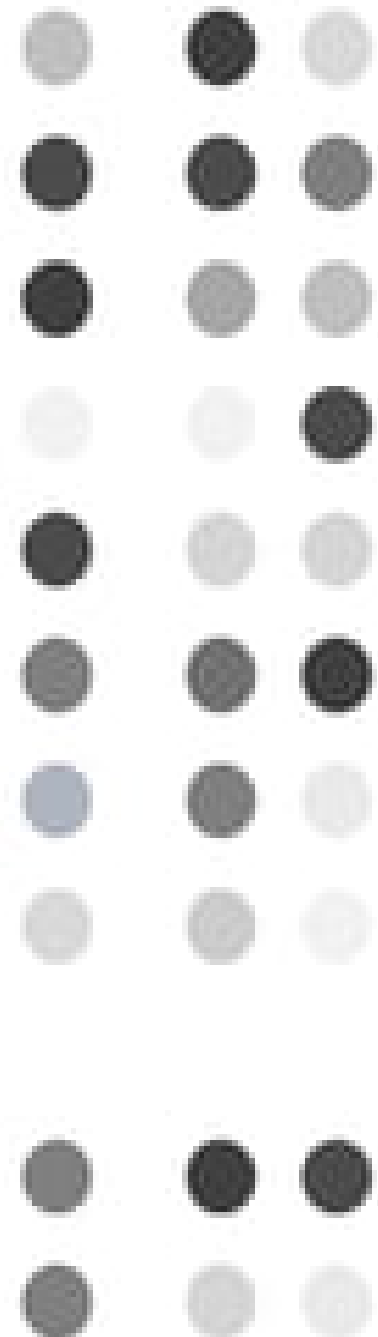
Technical writing document is not about opinion.



Characteristics

- Expressing information clearly.

No room for ambiguity!



Characteristics

- Using efficient words.

Verbiage

commence

endeavor

a large number of

in the majority of instances

the reason why is that

alternate choices

completely eliminate

connected together

an analysis of the data will be made

made a selection

Efficient

start

try

many

usually

because

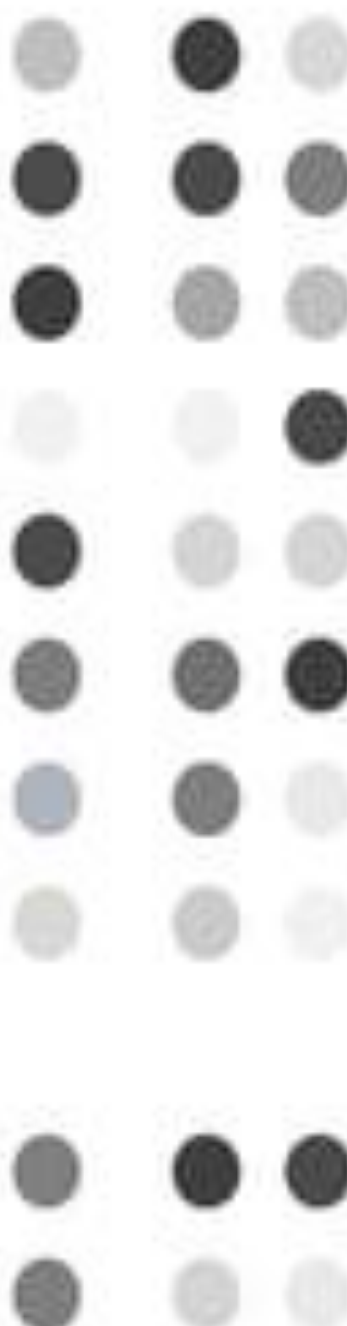
alternatives

eliminate

connected

data will be analyzed

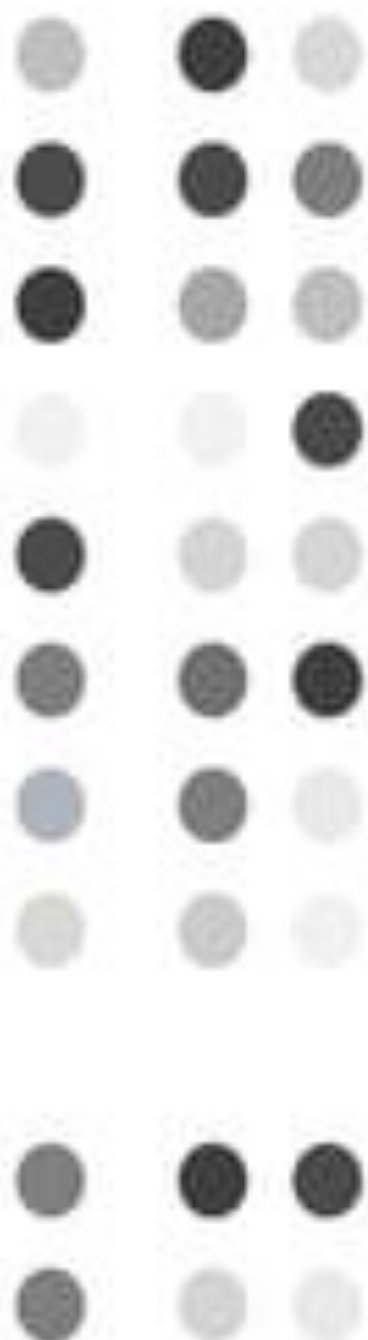
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Characteristics

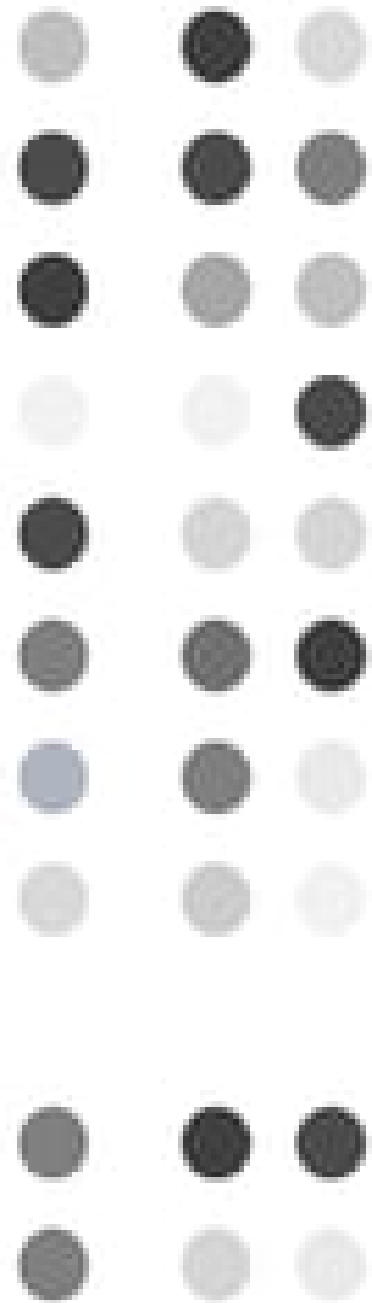
- Using appropriate writing style and the right punctuation marks.

Be careful of typos, sentences in conversational tone, and punctuation problems!



Effective Technical Writing

- **Clarity**
- **Conciseness**
- **Accuracy**
- **Organization**
- **Process**



Report writing:

Significance of Reports

Types of Reports

REPORT WRITING

- A report is a formal document written for a specific audience to meet a specific need. It may contains facts of a situation, project or process: an analysis and interpretation of data, events and records, inferences or conclusions drawn from objective data or suggestions and recommendations.

Purposes (objectives) of report waiting are:

- Presenting data.
- Describing and analyzing data.
- Discussing and analyzing data.
- Recording events and happenings.
- Analyzing a situation or a condition.
- Giving feedback, suggestions or recommendations.

Significance of Reports

Analysis

Report is very important because whenever any issue occurs, a group of committees try to find the reason for that issue and provide the whole scenario and results with or without the suggestion in the shape of report writing.

Improvement of Skill

Report writing helps you to improve the skills of designing, judgments, and means of communication. Therefore, these skills make a way to promote you.

Handle Complex Situation

In an organization that is based on a large scale, there might always have a problem of labor which may result in complex conditions. In order to handle this situation, managers make a report

Decision-making tool:

Organizations require a considerable amount of data and information on specific topics, scenarios, and situations. Managers and decision-makers often use business reports and research papers as information sources to make important business decisions and reach solutions.

Evaluation

Another reason that adds to the significance of report writing is that it is a collection of evaluated information.

Different types of activities by different departments define an organization. Think of the departments your organization has—development, sales, distribution, marketing, HR, and more.

Professional improvements:

During the annual appraisal cycle, your manager will ask you to write reports to explain your position, level of work, and performance.

If you have ever wondered how your manager decided to promote your colleague and not you, the answer may lie in his well-presented report.

Easy Tool

- Many of the reports make an easy way of activities for the managers.

In order for planning, promoting, controlling and managing. No doubt a report writing plays a vital role to help a manager as the report refers to as a source of information.

Characteristics of Report writing

1. Precision
2. Accuracy of Facts
3. Relevancy
4. Reader-Orientation
5. Direct Language
6. Compactness
7. Syntactic Accuracy
8. Fair Recommendation
9. Clearness
10. Appealing Presentation

FORMATS OF REPORT WRITING

The choice of format can be made according to the nature, length, scope, and function and type of audience.

SL. NO	Format	Description
1	Printed format	Forms prepared to record for repetitive and routine data.
2	Letter format	Short informal reports to be communicated to someone outside an organization.
3	Memo format	Short informal reports to be communicated to someone within an organization.
4	Manuscript	Formal reports printed on plain paper.

TYPES OF REPORTS

1. Event Reports
2. Project Reports
3. Book Reports
4. Meeting Reports
5. Scientific Reports
6. Technical Reports

1. Event Report: As the name suggests report on an event such as College Day, Dance program, and Independence Day function or Sports event is called 'Event Report'.

The Event Report should follow this pattern.

1. Introduction: The introduction tells the reader what the program was, it's a date, where it was held and often the names of the main participants, etc.

2. Body of the Report: Which describes the entire event in the right sequence the body of a report briefly describes every item of the event in the order in which that took place each of the items may be described who are evaluated in a sentence.

3. Conclusion: The conclusion of a report should make a final statement about an event.

2. Project Report: The project report is more Complex than an event report. It is a subject matter that usually has greater significance and a more detailed layout.

Parts of a Project Report
▪ Title page
▪ Foreword
▪ Abstract or Summary
▪ Contents
▪ Introduction
▪ Body of the Report
▪ Conclusion
▪ Recommendations
▪ Bibliography
▪ Glossary
▪ Index
▪ Illustrations

3. Book Report: A book report should have an introduction, a body and a conclusion.

Introduction: The first paragraph should introduce the whole report. It must give information about the title, the author, the year of publication, a brief description of the setting of the story.

Body of the book report: is the heart of the report. It introduces all the main characters, describes the conflict in the story and finally talks of how the conflict is resolved. This part of the report the way it is written is critical to the value of the whole report.

Conclusion: The concluding paragraph reveals the reader's own evaluation or personal opinion of the book. It must also identify the strengths and weaknesses of the book.

Introduction to Technical Proposal writing:

**Types of Technical
proposals**

**Characteristics of Technical
Proposals**

Introduction:

A proposal is an offer by one party to provide a product or service to another party in exchange for money.

It is a sales presentation, seeking to persuade the reader to accept the written plan for accomplishing a task.

Proposals are written offers to solve a technical problem or to undertake a project of practical or theoretical nature.

Purposes

To sale

To survey

To plan

To conduct

To train

To improve

Proposals are...

Valuable records to maintain

Index documents of company's growth

Means of financial returns

Tools to promote various activities

Tools to win contracts

Types

Sales proposal

Solicited proposal

Unsolicited proposal

Research proposal

Characteristics

Demonstrates needs

Creative

Informality and personal approach to some extent

Keeping in view customer's financial gain,
convenience and prestige

Neat and attractive

Including summary, background, objective,
description of the problem, methodology and cost
estimate

Providing suggestion

Fulfilling the requirement of solicitor

Purposeful and useful

Unambiguous in language expressions

Structure-Elements

1-Prefatory Parts:

- Title page
- Letter of transmittal
- Draft contract
- Table of contents
- List of tables/figures
- Executive summary

Structure-Elements

2-Body of proposal:

*Introduction:

- Problem

- Need

- Background

- Objectives

- Scope and limitation

*Technical procedures:

- Methods and sources

- Plan

*Managerial procedures:

- Sequence of activities

- Equipment, facilities, product

- Personal qualifications

- *Cost estimate

- *Conclusion

3-Supplementary Parts:

- Appendices

- References

Style & Appearance

Company logo

Visual aids

Graphs/Charts

Consistency

Accuracy

Correctness

Professional

Failure Factors

- 1-questionable project design
- 2-inadequate explanation of the research
- 3-lack of experience of the investigator

Grammar

Voices

&

Reported Speech

Active and Passive Voice



Verbs and Voice

- ❑ Voice is the form a verb takes to indicate whether the subject of the verb performs or receives the action.
- ❑ There are two types of voice: active voice and passive voice.

Active Voice

Active voice is used to show that the subject of the sentence is performing or causing the action.

Example:

Lebron threw the basketball before the buzzer.



Lebron shot the basketball from the free throw line.

Lebron scored three points.

Passive Voice

Passive voice is used when the subject is the recipient of the action.

Example:

The ball was thrown by Lebron.

The basket was shot by Lebron.

The score was made by Lebron.



Tense	Active	Passive
Simple Present	They <u>supply</u> notebooks.	Notebooks <u>are supplied</u> by them.
	My brother always <u>irritates</u> me.	I <u>am</u> always <u>irritated</u> by my brother.
	The Principal <u>uses</u> a green pen.	A green pen <u>is used</u> by the Principal.
Simple Past	They <u>supplied</u> notebooks.	Notebooks <u>were supplied</u> by them.
	My brother always <u>irritated</u> me.	I <u>was</u> always <u>irritated</u> by my brother.
	The Principal <u>used</u> a green pen.	A green pen <u>was used</u> by the Principal.

Present Continuous

They are supplying notebooks.

My brother is irritating me.

The Principal is using a green pen.

Notebooks are being supplied by them.

I am always being irritated by my brother.

A green pen is being used by the Principal.

Past Continuous

They were supplying notebooks.

My brother was always irritating me.

The Principal was using a green pen.

Notebooks were being supplied by them.

I was always being irritated by my brother.

A green pen was being used by the Principal.

Present Perfect

They have supplied notebooks.

Notebooks have been supplied by them.

My brother has always irritated me.

I have always been irritated by my brother.

The Principal has used a green pen.

A green pen has been used by the Principal.

Tense	Active	Passive
Past Perfect	They <u>had supplied</u> notebooks.	Notebooks <u>had been supplied</u> by them.
	My brother <u>had</u> always <u>irritated</u> me.	I <u>had</u> always <u>been irritated</u> by my brother.
	The Principal <u>had used</u> a green pen.	A green pen <u>had been used</u> by the Principal.

Use of passive voice

The passive voice is usually used in the following situations:

1. When the focus is on the object: e.g. Our bank has been robbed!
2. The subject is general or is irrelevant: e.g. The shops were forcibly shut today during the *bandh*.
3. The speaker wants to hide the identity of the subject: e.g. The window pane was broken today.
4. The subject has too many details and the speaker wants to introduce the subject later in the sentence: e.g. This part of the programme was sponsored by ABC Motors, Jinal Spices, Digizone Smartphone Network and Dreamz Computers.

Change the voice of these sentences.

1. The fashion sensibilities shown by the upcoming designers amazed us.
2. The fabric has been cut and styled by the contestants.
3. The hair stylist has demanded a huge sum to participate in the reality show.
4. Her innate sense of style has been widely appreciated by the fashion police.
5. This designer has made a conscious decision to stay away from leather and pure silk.
6. They sold shopping bags made out of leftover pieces of cloth to discourage the use of plastic.
7. The khadi and village industries board is promoting the use of natural fabrics.
8. Corporate organisations expect employees to turn up for work well-groomed and suitably attired.

Grammar

REPORTED SPEECH

We use reported speech to talk about *what was said or thought in the past*. Here are some examples of reported speech.

I thought that you were in America.

My mother always told me that I spoke too much.

I heard him say that he would read the book.

Converting direct speech to *reported speech* can be done in a few simple steps. Let's take an example of direct speech.

'I cannot accept your resignation today.'

- Step 1:** You have to know who the speaker of this sentence is. Let us say that it was a *supervisor* who said that line. Sometimes, you may need to replace the noun with a pronoun like 'I', 'she', 'he', 'they' etc.
- Step 2:** You will need to know who the speech was addressed to. This is not always required, but some verbs like 'told' need to have this information accompanying them. Let us assume that the example sentence in direct speech was addressed to you.
- Step 3:** You will need a reporting verb like 'tell', 'say', 'shout', 'whisper', 'mumble' etc. You will need to change the tense of this sentence depending upon when it was said and by whom.
- Step 4:** Pronouns used in direct speech may need to be changed in reported speech in order to keep the meaning unchanged. For example, 'you' may become 'me', 'her' may become 'you' etc.
- Step 5:** You may need to change any reference to time within the sentence. For example, 'today' in direct speech may change to 'that day', unless it was being reported on the same day.
- Step 6:** You will need to remove the quotation marks, exclamation marks or question marks that were a part of the sentence in direct speech.

So the same sentence in reported speech reads:

The supervisor told me that he could not accept my resignation that day.

Here are some more examples of such conversions. Pay attention to the underlined words.

Direct speech	Reported speech
He said, 'Why are you late?'	He asked her why she <u>was</u> late.
I said, 'Could you please help me?'	I asked her <u>if</u> she could help me.
The mayor said, 'Sit down!'	The mayor <u>ordered</u> him to sit down.
I said to them, 'I will see you this afternoon.'	I told them that I would see them <u>that</u> afternoon.
The tailor said, 'Will you come back tomorrow?'	The tailor <u>asked me if I would</u> come back <u>the next day</u> .

Conversion from reported speech to direct speech

Look at this example of a sentence in reported speech being converted to direct speech.

Reported speech:

He exclaimed that he was alarmed at the insensitivity of the politician's remarks.

Direct speech:

He exclaimed, 'I am alarmed at the insensitivity of the politician's remarks'.

Note the changes made:

1. Deletion of 'that'
2. Placing of a comma between the reporting part and the reported part of the sentence
3. Change in the pronoun 'he' to 'I'
4. Change in the tense of the verb 'alarm'
5. Use of quotation marks to indicate the reported part of the sentence

Task 3

Task 3

Convert these sentences to reported speech.

1. The reporter said, 'The elections will be held tomorrow.'
2. The teacher said, 'You need to hurry.'

3. She said, 'I will speak with you later.'
4. Julie's brother said, 'I haven't seen my sister all day today.'
5. The student said, 'Are marks more important than learning?'

Task 4

Convert these sentences to direct speech.

1. He said that he had checked the calculations.
2. She claimed that she was a qualified graphic designer.
3. My colleague told the client that our company would bear the transportation cost.
4. I requested the air hostess to bring me a cup of coffee.
5. The guest remarked that he was humbled by the warm reception given to him by the hosts.